

Group 5

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Who lives in high-quality housing?

Inequalities in Housing Conditions Across Intersected Social Groups

Background

Housing Quality (OECD, 2021)

- Housing condition
- Housing affordability

Housing Conditions

- **Health** (Chapman et al. 2023)
- **Wellbeing** (Riva et al. 2022; Clapham 2018)
- Economic **mobility** (Ramakrishnan 2021)

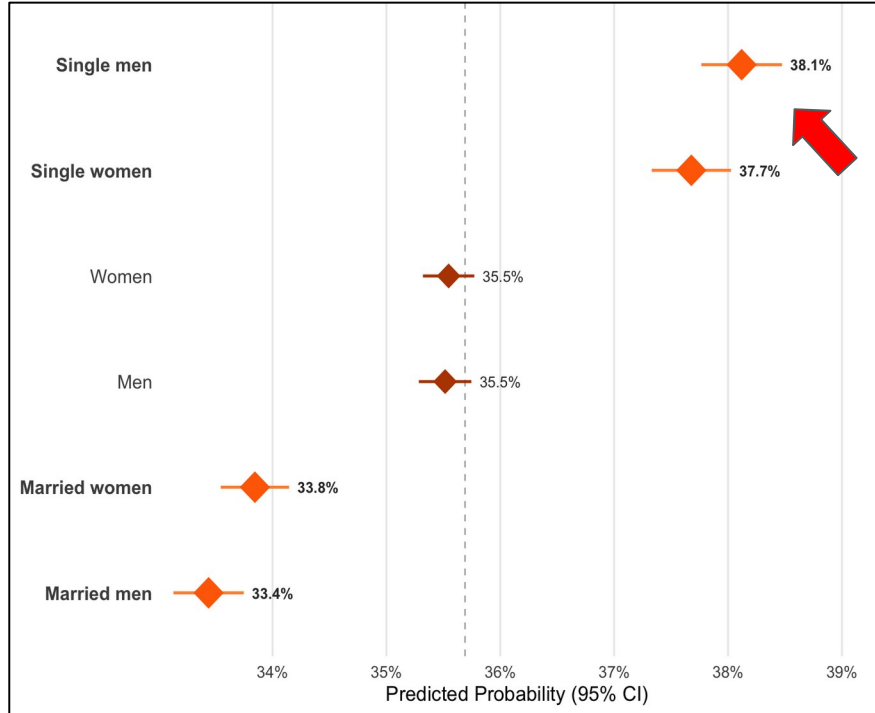
Hidden housing risk

- Access stratified by race, immigrant status, and other social locations (Hulchanski, 2007; Swope & Hernandez, 2019)
- Invisible housing **risk lies at the intersection of social locations**
- **Marital status** and **parenthood** rise as social inequality indicators (MacLanahan and Percheski 2008)

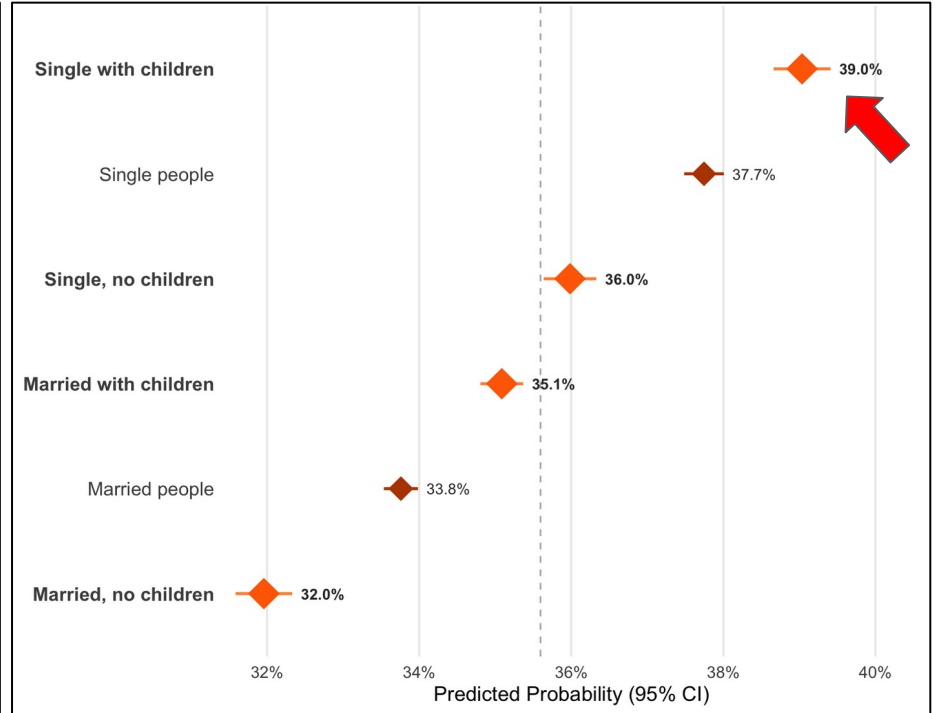
Family characteristics

- Consequential for household income and economic mobility
- Poor housing - economic pressure - family formations

About **2 in 5 single men** live in a dwelling needing repair



Nearly **2 in 5 single parents** live in a dwelling needing repair



Notes: Data are drawn from the *Socioeconomic–Mortality Linked Synthetic Dataset (February 2021)*. The analytical sample is restricted to individuals aged 18–65. Estimates are derived from binary logistic regression models predicting the likelihood that a dwelling is in need of repair (1 = needs repair; 0 = no need for repair). Key independent variables are constructed from parenthood status, marital status and gender. Income, education and minority status are controlled.

Policy implications

Single-parent households

- Prioritize **direct repair funding** for urgent health and safety risks
- Provide **hands-on navigation support** to ensure repairs actually happen

Single men

- Expand **rapid, low-barrier repair assistance** (no credit, minimal paperwork)
- Enforce **accountability for landlords** in substandard rental housing

Takeaway

Housing policy must move beyond access toward **maintenance equity**

Safe, livable housing is an **ongoing right, not a one-time provision**



THANK YOU!